

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 722

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to affirm the State of Tennessee's support for the State of Israel, our greatest friend and ally in the Middle East, and to express our solidarity with Israel's right to defend itself against terror attacks, and commemorate the final return of all hostages from the Hamas October 7, 2023, terror attacks.

WHEREAS, the State of Israel, the only democracy in the Middle East, is the greatest friend, ally, and strategic partner of the United States in the region; and

WHEREAS, there is a strong historic fellowship of religious, cultural, economic, business, social, governmental, and educational relationships between the United States of America, the State of Tennessee, and the State of Israel; and

WHEREAS, Israel is a valued economic partner of the State of Tennessee. In 2025, Tennessee exported \$95.7 million worth of manufactured goods to Israel. Since 2021, Tennessee exports to Israel have totaled more than \$442 million, and Israel now ranks as Tennessee's fortieth leading trading partner; and

WHEREAS, the continued cooperation between the State of Tennessee and Israel is mutually beneficial and of significant importance; and

WHEREAS, 2026 marks seventy-eight years of robust United States and Israel relations, reflected in the relations between the State of Tennessee and Israel, a special relationship based on mutually shared democratic values, common strategic interests, and moral bonds of friendship and mutual respect; and

WHEREAS, once again, we recognize the importance of expressing our unabridged support for the Jewish people and the State of Israel's right to exist and its right to free trade; and

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee is a supporter of the State of Israel and its right to defend itself against terror and any threat to its security; and

WHEREAS, on October 7, 2023, the terrorist group Hamas launched a surprise attack from Gaza on multiple population centers in southern Israel; and

WHEREAS, at least 1,400 Israelis—mostly civilians—were massacred by terrorists, including civilians brutally tortured and murdered in their homes and young people gunned down at a music festival; and

WHEREAS, Hamas terrorists kidnapped and dragged into Gaza 250 men, women, children, toddlers, and infants; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. State Department has confirmed that dozens of Americans were killed or taken hostage in these attacks; and

WHEREAS, the State of Israel has conducted a just war of self-defense on behalf of the free world in the face of evil and terror; and

WHEREAS, after more than two years of continuous resilience, sacrifice, and courage on behalf of the Israeli Defense Forces and the Israeli people and after 843 days, all hostages brutally held in captivity by Hamas have finally been returned; and

WHEREAS, 2026 also marks the first year in which there are no Israeli hostages held by Hamas since 2013; and

WHEREAS, it is our hope that these conditions will pave the way for greater regional cooperation; and

WHEREAS, the United States played a key role in establishing the historic Abraham Accords, normalizing relations between Israel, the United Arab Emirates, Bahrain, and Morocco; and

WHEREAS, the Abraham Accords will continue to usher in a new era of peace and economic prosperity between Israel and Arab countries working together for a better future for their peoples; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby affirm the State of Tennessee's support for the State of Israel and express our solidarity with Israel's right to defend itself against terror attacks as we commemorate the final return of all hostages from the Hamas October 7, 2023, terror attacks.